before restoring old buildings. So many of India's people were poor and hungry. Better ways of farming had to be developed. Factories also needed to be built.

However, it soon became clear that the Taj Mahal was a great tourist attraction. Visitors from all over the world came to see it. They spent money that helped the economy of India.

That convinced the government to step up efforts to restore the Taj Mahal. Its goal was to make the building look the way it had originally. Historians searched for documents about the construction of the building and its gardens. Scientists tried to determine exactly what kinds of plants had been in the gardens.

In 1983, an agency of the United Nations (UNESCO) put the Taj Mahal and the Red Fort of Agra on its list of World Heritage Sites. This helped get more money to restore the Taj Mahal.

### World Heritage Sites

**UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization) has created a list of World Heritage Sites. These are more than a thousand places that are particularly important in world culture. Some, like the Taj Mahal, were made by humans. Others, such as the Grand Canyon, are natural formations.**

**There are twenty-three World Heritage Sites in the United States. They range from the Hawaii Volcanoes National Park to the Statue of Liberty. Canada has seventeen sites, and India has thirty-two. Besides the Taj Mahal, those related to events in this book are the Red Fort in Agra and the Red Fort in Delhi.**